WEEK 5 · UNIT II · CLO 2 AND CLO 5 · STUDENT PACK

Talent Acquisition, Onboarding and Learning Systems

How firms find, welcome and develop people, and how to design all three for a frontline, smartphone-only, multilingual workforce.

L1 Talent acquisition and digital onboarding: signals, fit, fairness, India Stack

L2 Learning systems: LMS, LXP and skills platforms, the Infosys Lex case, a store learning path

L3 The rollout: what adoption data shows, and the divide as an adoption risk

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SESSION MAP · TWO HOURS

Today in three parts, each anchored in theory

A · Talent acquisition

0:00 to 0:35

Signaling, selection validity, ASA, disparate impact routes, applicant justice

Revisit: Round 4

B · Digital onboarding

0:35 to 1:15

Socialization tactics, adjustment, uncertainty reduction, psychological contract, Four Cs

C · Learning systems

1:15 to 2:00

Andragogy, SDT, desirable difficulties, Kirkpatrick and its critics, transfer

Revisit: Round 3

The thread: each system makes a promise about people. Theory turns the promise into a prediction we can test.

SOCRATIC OPENER · GL-1001

Lakshmi Naidu, Store Associate, Warangal (Tier 3). Smartphone only, prefers Telugu, 42 months at GreenLeaf. Her one learning record: POSH Compliance, self paced, In-progress, assessment 32 percent.

Was she ever recruited, onboarded and trained, or only processed?

Source: GreenLeaf workbook, Employee_Master and LMS_Learning, row GL-1001

PART A · 0:00 TO 0:35

Talent acquisition: signals, fit and fairness

What does an applicant tracking system read, and what does it miss?

Why do screening models drift toward the past?

How do candidates judge a digital process?

PART A · FIRST, WHAT IS TALENT?

Talent is a product of three Cs, not a sum

Competence

Can do

The knowledge, skills and values the job needs now and in future.

×

Commitment

Will do

The effort and energy a person chooses to give the organization.

×

Contribution

Wants to do

Finding meaning and purpose in the work, so effort lasts.

If any one C is zero, talent is zero. For GL-1001: which C did a 32 percent course score actually measure?

Source: Ulrich, D. and Smallwood, N. (2012). What is talent? *Leader to Leader*, 2012(63), 55 to 61.

PART A · THEORY 1

Hiring is a two way signaling problem

The employer reads the candidate

Spence (1973): when quality is hidden, employers rely on costly signals such as degrees and experience.

An ATS turns signals into keywords and cut offs, so it reads only what was written in its vocabulary.

The candidate reads the employer

Rynes, Bretz and Gerhart (1991): applicants treat delays, tone and process quality as signals of how the firm treats people.

A silent auto rejection is also a signal.

Design question: what does our ATS signal to a Tier 3 walk in applicant, and what can it not read about her?

PART A · THEORY 1b

A screen is only as useful as its validity

Taylor and Russell (1939)

A selection tool adds value through three things together:

validity (does the score predict performance?), the **selection ratio** and the **base rate** of good performers.

Meta analytic evidence

Schmidt and Hunter (1998); revised by Sackett et al. (2022).

Structured interviews rank among the most valid methods; unstructured ones rank lower.

Keyword screens are rarely validated at all.

Rigor test for any ATS: what is its validity against later job performance, and who measured it?

PART A · THEORY 2

The ASA cycle explains why screening models copy the past

Attraction
Similar people apply

→

Selection
Firm picks people like current staff

→

Attrition
Those who do not fit leave

→

Sameness
The workforce narrows

Schneider (1987)

“The people make the place”: attraction, selection and attrition together make an organization more alike over time.

Kristof (1996)

Person organization fit (values) differs from person job fit (skills). A model trained on past hires learns both, mixed.

PART A · THEORY 2b

Five routes by which a hiring model produces disparate impact

Route (Barocas and Selbst, 2016)	How it enters a GreenLeaf screen
1. Target variable	“Good hire” defined as long tenure, which favors groups that faced fewer breaks
2. Labeled examples	Past offers, already skewed, used as the training answer key
3. Feature selection	Fields chosen that exist for some applicants and not others
4. Proxies	Career gap or college stands in for gender or class
5. Masking	A biased choice hidden inside a neutral looking model

Barocas, S. and Selbst, A. D. (2016). Big data's disparate impact. California Law Review, 104(3), 671 to 732.

PART A · THEORY 3

Candidates judge the process, not only the result

Gilliland’s procedural rule (1993)	What a typical ATS does
Job relatedness	Does a keyword match track the job?
Opportunity to perform	Rejected before any human contact
Consistency	Same rule for all: a real strength
Feedback	Silent rejection, no reason given
Two way communication	A chatbot, or nothing

Gilliland, S. W. (1993). The perceived fairness of selection systems. Academy of Management Review, 18(4).

REVISIT · ROUND 4

The algorithmic screen fails the four fifths test

0.60

Algorithm used (77 requisitions)
Female selection 8.32% ÷ male 13.88%

0.98

No algorithm (63 requisitions)
Female selection 13.04% ÷ male 13.32%

Threshold 0.80. Adverse impact is judged on outcomes; intent does not matter. Which theory from the last two slides explains how the gap arose?

Source: Recruitment_ATS. Selection rate = Offers ÷ Applications for each gender, totals pooled by Algorithm_Used.

PART B · 0:35 TO 1:15

Onboarding is socialization, not paperwork

Which design choices does every onboarding make?

What should onboarding actually produce in a newcomer?

Where does India Stack help, and where does it stop?

PART B · THEORY 4

Six choices every onboarding design makes

Institutionalized	Individualized
Collective	Individual
Formal	Informal
Sequential	Random
Fixed	Variable
Serial	Disjunctive
Investiture	Divestiture

What Jones (1986) found

Institutionalized tactics: less role ambiguity, more commitment, a custodial role.

Individualized tactics: more role innovation.

Van Maanen and Schein (1979), Toward a theory of organizational socialization; Jones (1986), Academy of Management Journal.

PART B · THEORY 5

What onboarding must produce: three adjustment states

Inputs

Socialization tactics; the newcomer's own information seeking

→

Adjustment

Role clarity
Self efficacy
Social acceptance

→

Outcomes

Performance, satisfaction, commitment, intention to stay

Measure the middle box. Completion of onboarding tasks is an input, not an outcome.

Bauer, Bodner, Erdogan, Truxillo and Tucker (2007), meta analysis, Journal of Applied Psychology, 92(3).

PART B · THEORY 5b

Newcomers reduce uncertainty by seeking information

Uncertainty reduction

Berger and Calabrese (1975): people in new relationships act to make others predictable.

Newcomers do the same with the organization.

Seeking tactics

Miller and Jablin (1991): overt questions, indirect questions, third parties, testing limits, observing, surveillance.

A chatbot serves only the first.

What they seek

Morrison (1993): technical, referent (role), normative, performance feedback, social.

Normative and social answers come from people.

Prediction: a digital first onboarding answers technical questions well and leaves normative and social uncertainty unresolved.

PART B · THEORY 5c

Onboarding writes the psychological contract

Rousseau (1989; 1995)

Beliefs about mutual promises, held by the employee.

Transactional: pay for work, short term.

Relational: loyalty, growth, long term.

Early breach

Robinson and Rousseau (1994): a majority of new graduates reported a broken promise within two years.

Breach predicted lower trust and higher exit.

Realistic previews

Wanous: met expectations. Premack and Wanous (1985) meta analysis: previews lower inflated expectations; effect on retention is small but reliable.

Design rule: every promise a recruiting app or welcome video makes is a term of the contract the first month must honor.

PART B · THEORY 6

Bauer’s Four Cs: most firms stop at the first

Compliance

Rules, forms, policy sign offs

Clarification

Role and expectations

Culture

Norms, written and unwritten

Connection

Relationships and networks

Passive onboarding

Compliance and some Clarification

Proactive onboarding

All four, planned on purpose

Bauer, T. N. (2010). Onboarding new employees: Maximizing success. SHRM Foundation.

PART B · SYNTHESIS

Three onboarding frameworks, three units of analysis

Framework	What it describes	What it misses
Van Maanen and Schein (1979)	How the organization structures entry (tactics)	The newcomer's own seeking
Bauer (2010), Four Cs	What content onboarding covers	How content is delivered
Klein and Polin (2012): inform, welcome, guide	Concrete practices firms use	Outcomes in the newcomer
Bauer et al. (2007)	Adjustment states and outcomes	Specific practices to use

Rigor rule: use a process framework to design, and an outcome model to evaluate. Mixing them up is the commonest error.

PART B · APPLICATION

India Stack: the onboarding rail for a frontline hire

Aadhaar eKYC
Identity verified in minutes

→

DigiLocker
Verified documents, no photocopies

→

eSign
Offer and policies signed on a phone

→

Bank check
Account confirmed for first salary

Every step pulls personal data. Name its purpose and collect only what is needed (DPDP Act 2023).

The rail completes Compliance. It does nothing for Culture or Connection.

L1 · DIGITAL ONBOARDING

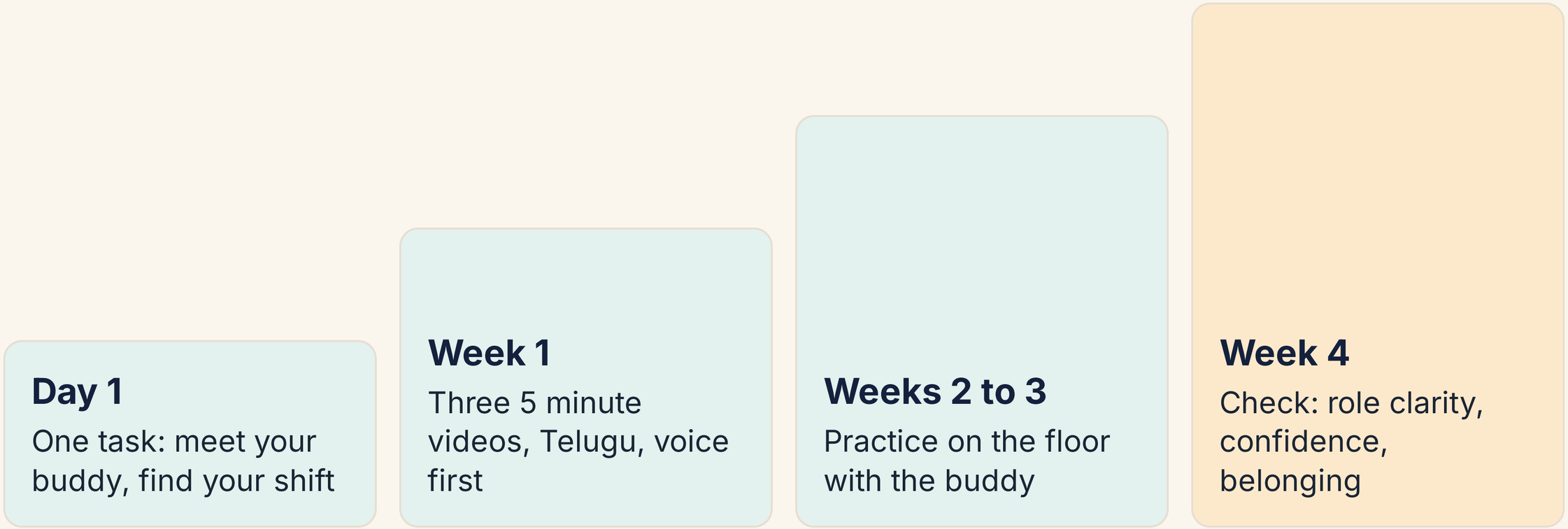
Frontline and corporate onboarding are different journeys

	Corporate new hire	Frontline new hire (like GL-1001)
Device	Laptop issued on day one	Own smartphone; often shared data
Language	English portal works	Needs Telugu, Hindi or another regional language
Documents	Email upload and e-sign	DigiLocker, Aadhaar eKYC and e-sign from the phone
First week	Induction sessions and a manager meeting	On the shop floor in shifts, with a buddy
Success measure	Time to productivity	Still here at 90 days

DESIGN RULE Build the frontline journey first. The corporate journey is the easier special case.

PART B · THEORY 7

Cognitive load: build the first month as a staircase



Sweller (1988), Cognitive load during problem solving, Cognitive Science. Example journey for GL-1001, for discussion.

THE HINGE OF THE SESSION

A document checklist completes onboarding for the HRIS. Only connection completes it for the person.

PART C · 1:15 TO 2:00

Learning systems should change behavior, not count completions

How do adults learn, and what follows for design?

Why micro and spaced learning?

What did GreenLeaf’s data say about training?

PART C · THEORY 8

How adults learn: two theories set the design brief

Knowles: andragogy (1980)

Adults need to know why.

They direct their own learning.

Experience is the main resource.

They learn around real problems.

Kolb: experiential cycle (1984)

1 Concrete experience

2 Reflective observation

3 Abstract conceptualization

4 Active experimentation

Caution: matching teaching to “learning styles” has no good evidence (Pashler et al., 2008).

PART C · THEORY 8b

Self determination theory: why points and badges backfire

Three basic needs

Deci and Ryan (1985); Ryan and Deci (2000).

Autonomy, **competence** and **relatedness** sustain intrinsic motivation.

Overjustification

Deci, Koestner and Ryan (1999), meta analysis: expected tangible rewards undermined intrinsic motivation for interesting tasks.

Informational feedback did not.

Design consequences

Choice of path (autonomy).

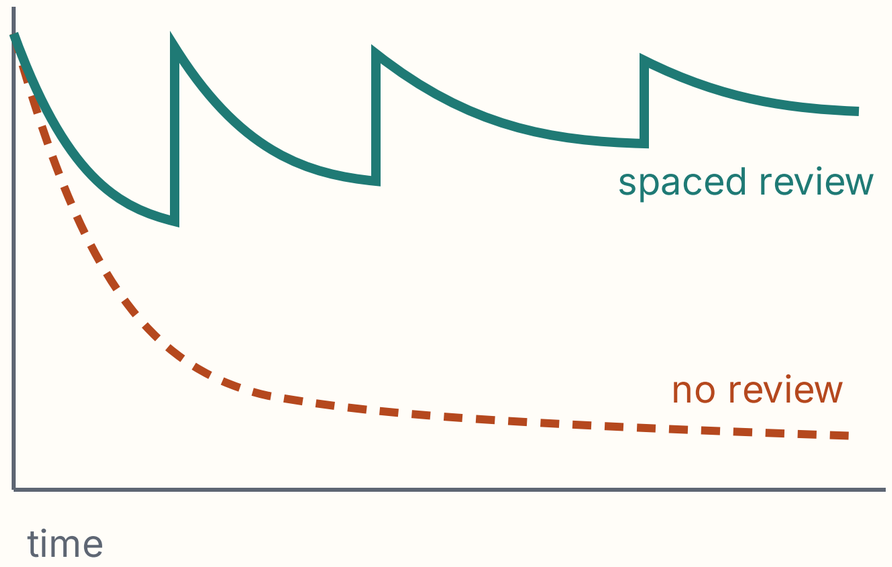
Visible skill growth (competence).

Learning with peers (relatedness).

This is the theory behind the Round 3 caution: extrinsic rewards create activity without capability.

PART C · THEORY 9

Why micro and spaced: the forgetting curve



Three findings

Ebbinghaus (1885): memory fades fast without review.

Spacing effect: spread practice beats one long session (Cepeda et al., 2006).

Mayer: short segments, clear signals, no clutter.

The curve is illustrative, not data. Mayer, R. E. (2009). Multimedia Learning, 2nd ed. Cambridge University Press.

PART C · THEORY 9b

Desirable difficulties: what makes learning stick

Principle	Finding	Mobile design at GreenLeaf
Spacing	Spread practice beats massed (Cepeda et al., 2006)	Short refreshers on days 2, 7 and 21
Retrieval practice	Testing beats rereading (Roediger and Karpicke, 2006)	Quiz before the content, not after
Interleaving	Mixed problems beat blocked ones (Rohrer and Taylor, 2007)	Mix leave, payslip and shift tasks
Segmenting	Learner paced short parts help novices (Mayer, 2009)	One task per two minute clip

Bjork, R. A. (1994). Memory and metamemory considerations in the training of human beings.

PART C · PLATFORMS

LMS, LXP, skills platform: three different logics

	LMS	LXP	Skills platform
Organizing unit	Course	Content experience	Skill
Who chooses	HR assigns	Learner browses	Role gap drives
Main metric	Completion	Engagement	Proficiency gain
Best GreenLeaf use	Compliance	Corporate staff	Frontline reskilling

Case: Infosys Lex. As you read it, ask which organizing unit Lex chose, and what that choice made measurable.

L2 · CASE

Infosys Lex: digital learning at scale

What it is

Infosys's in-house learning platform, launched for its own employees in April 2018. Cloud first and mobile first.

114,000+

Scale

Used by more than 114,000 Infosys employees within months of launch.

How it works

Machine-learning course suggestions, learning playlists, and content that employees create and share.

Then sold outside

In September 2018 Infosys began offering the same platform to client firms as Infosys Wingspan.

The question for GreenLeaf

Infosys staff are graduates on laptops who read English. What would have to change for Lakshmi Naidu?

SOURCE Infosys press release, 20 September 2018. Transfer the design principle, not the product.

L2 · DESIGN EXERCISE

A first-month learning path for a GreenLeaf store associate

Week	Course in GreenLearn	Design choice
1	Using the GreenLeaf ESS App	Five-minute videos in the associate's language, on the phone
2	POSH Compliance	Short scenarios, not a long text module
3	Customer Service Excellence	Practiced on the floor with a buddy (blended)
4	Inventory Systems	Hands-on with the store's scanner, then a short check
Ongoing	Data Privacy and DPDP Basics	Spaced refreshers, not one sitting

THE EVIDENCE

Lakshmi's one course, POSH, is In-progress with a score of 32%. Smartphone-only staff complete 61% of courses; laptop users 90%. Source: LMS_Learning joined to Employee_Master.

PART C · THEORY 10

Kirkpatrick’s four levels, mapped to GreenLeaf’s tabs

4	**Results**	Helpdesk load, attrition, store KPIs	**PeopleAnalytics_Fact**
3	**Behavior**	ESS logins and self service use	**Adoption_Telemetry**
2	**Learning**	Assessment score, completion	**LMS_Learning**
1	**Reaction**	Did learners value it?	**Not collected**

Kirkpatrick (1959); Kirkpatrick and Kirkpatrick (2016), Kirkpatrick’s Four Levels of Training Evaluation, ATD Press.

PART C · CRITIQUE

The four levels are not a causal chain

Alliger et al. (1997)

Meta analysis: reactions correlated only weakly with learning and with on the job behavior.

Judgments of usefulness did better than enjoyment.

Holton (1996)

The model is a taxonomy, not a theory: it names outcomes without explaining why one leads to another.

Context and motivation are left out.

So a high Level 2 score licenses no claim about Level 3. You must measure behavior directly, which GreenLeaf’s data allows.

PART C · THEORY 10b

Transfer of training: the missing causal model

Inputs

Trainee: ability, motivation
Design: practice, relevance
Work environment: support, chance to use

→

Learning

Learned and retained

→

Transfer

Used on the job and kept up

Blume et al. (2010) meta analysis: work environment support and motivation relate to transfer. A module cannot supply the store manager who lets you use what you learned.

Baldwin, T. T. and Ford, J. K. (1988). Transfer of training: A review and directions for future research. Personnel Psychology, 41(1).

EVIDENCE · LEVEL 3

Finishing the onboarding module did not change behavior

16.6 vs 16.4

ESS logins per month: completed the module (241) vs did not (239)

34.0% vs 33.9%

Share at the Advocacy stage: completed vs did not

39.0% vs 34.7%

Share still at Awareness: completers sit there more often

Level 2 says yes. Level 3 says nothing moved. Which one should the Board hear?

Source: Adoption_Telemetry (480 sampled active employees). Training_Completed against ESS_Logins_per_Month and Adoption_Stage.

EVIDENCE · RIGOR CHECK

Four rival explanations to rule out before concluding

Rival explanation	Why it matters here
Sample restriction	Telemetry covers 480 sampled active users, not all 1,000
Weak measure	Training_Completed is one module, recorded only as Yes or No
Reverse selection	Confident users may skip training and use ESS anyway
Cross section	One month of logins; no before and after comparison

A stronger design: stagger the rollout across stores and compare change in use, before and after (difference in differences).

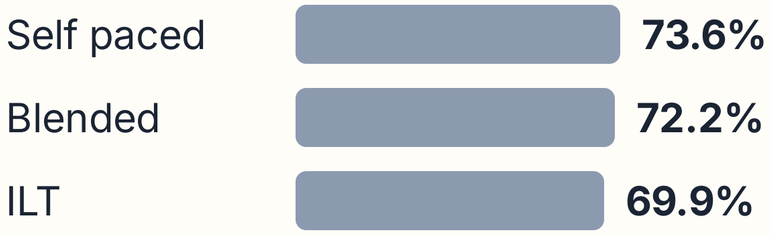
EVIDENCE · ACCESS

Completion follows access, not delivery mode

Digital skills courses, by tier



All courses, by mode



All courses, by device



Source: LMS_Learning joined to Employee_Master; share Completed. Tier gap 36.2 points; mode spread 3.7 points.

REVISIT · ROUND 3

Did your rollout fix match the barrier?

Barrier	What it looks like	Matching lens	Tempting wrong fix
Access	No device or data on shift	**Digital inclusion: access layer**	More training modules
Ability	Knows how, cannot yet do it	**ADKAR Ability: coached practice**	More e-learning
Desire	Sees no reason to use it	**ADKAR Desire; champions (Rogers)**	Points and badges

Open your pod’s Round 3 submission. Which row did your chosen option actually address? Defend it in two sentences.

SYNTHESIS · THEORY LEDGER

Each theory makes a prediction the workbook can test

Theory	Prediction	Test and result
ASA; Barocas and Selbst	Gap appears where the model screens	Recruitment_ATS: 0.60 vs 0.98. Supported
Baldwin and Ford	Completion without work support leaves use flat	Adoption_Telemetry: 16.6 vs 16.4. Consistent
Digital inclusion: access	Completion falls as access falls	LMS by device: 90.1% vs 51.3%. Supported
Bauer et al. (2007)	Adjustment predicts staying	No adjustment measure. Untestable: a data gap

All figures recomputed from GreenLeaf_Disha_DSEH001_Dataset_v2.xlsx.

THREE TAKEAWAYS

1. An ATS is a selection method: ask for its validity. The four fifths test detects the gap; ASA and Barocas and Selbst explain it.

2. Onboarding succeeds when adjustment rises: role clarity, self efficacy, acceptance. Design with a process framework, evaluate with an outcome model.

3. Completion is not transfer. Baldwin and Ford predict flat use without work support, and GreenLeaf’s data agrees, pending rival explanations.

READINGS AND AFTER CLASS

Before next week

Read

Scully-Russ (2019): re-read for the learning and HRD lens

Case: Infosys Lex, digital reskilling at scale

NASSCOM FutureSkills: selected sections

Do

AI consolidation: design a four week onboarding journey for GL-1001 with no laptop and no English, then critique it with the Four Cs.

Forum: one Indian firm’s digital onboarding story. Who might it still exclude?

Theory sources named on the slides are for reference; the readings above are the required ones.